



MO COACH DRILL BOOK

90 real basketball drills for young players
in 10 chapters



Mo



Arff



Meow



Hop



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Chapter 1 — Ball Handling & Dribbling

10 drills

1 Pound Dribbles

Dribble the ball hard and low, 20 times with your right hand, then 20 with your left. Eyes up the whole time.

Coach tip: Fingertips, not the palm. The harder you pound, the more control you get.

2 Crossover Taps

Bounce the ball from your right hand to your left and back, low in front of your knees. Go 30 seconds.

Coach tip: Keep it below your knees so no one can steal it.

3 Figure Eights

Weave the ball between your legs in a figure-eight, slow and smooth. 10 times each direction.

Coach tip: Start slow. Smooth beats fast.

4 Spider Dribble

Tap the ball quickly — front-front, back-back — between your legs. Count how many taps in 20 seconds.

Coach tip: Tiny quick taps with your fingertips.

5 Wall Taps

Stand close to a wall and tap the ball against it with your fingertips, fast, for 30 seconds.

Coach tip: This builds strong, quick fingers for handling.

6 Two-Ball Dribble

Dribble two balls at once, both hands pounding together, then take turns (right up, left down).

Coach tip: Keep your head UP — feel the balls, don't watch them.

7 Zig-Zag Dribble

Dribble in a zig-zag down the court, crossing over each time you change direction.

Coach tip: Push off your outside foot when you change directions.

8 Stop and Go

Dribble fast, freeze on 'STOP', then explode again on 'GO'.

Coach tip: Low and balanced when you stop so you're ready to move.

9 Around the World

Circle the ball around your waist, then your knees, then your ankles, without dropping it.

Coach tip: Fast hands! Then go the other way.

10 Cone Weave

Set up cones (or shoes) in a line and dribble in and out of them with control.

Coach tip: Change hands at every cone.



Chapter 2 — Passing

10 drills

1 Chest Pass Partners

Face a partner and chest-pass back and forth. Step into every pass. Do 20 clean passes.

Coach tip: Thumbs point down when the ball leaves your hands — that's a good chest pass.

2 Bounce Pass

Bounce-pass to a partner so the ball bounces once, about two-thirds of the way to them.

Coach tip: Aim the bounce, not the person.

3 Pass and Move

Pass to a partner, then sprint to a new spot. They pass it back. Never stand still.

Coach tip: Good players move right after they pass.

4 Wall Passing

Chest-pass against a wall and catch it back, fast, for 30 seconds.

Coach tip: Great when you're practicing alone.

5 Find the Open One

Three players stand in a line, one raises a hand. Pass to the open hand, then a new one opens.

Coach tip: Look before you pass — pass to the one who's ready.

6 Monkey in the Middle

Two passers, one defender in the middle. Keep the ball away with good passes.

Coach tip: Fake one way, pass the other.

7 Overhead Outlet

Grab a rebound and make a strong two-hand pass over your head to a partner up the court.

Coach tip: Turn and look up the floor first.

8 No-Look Practice

Look one way and pass another to a partner (only when you've mastered the basics!).

Coach tip: Learn the normal pass first — fancy comes later.

9 Star Passing

Five players in a star shape passing across in a pattern. Keep it smooth and quick.

Coach tip: Call your teammate's name before you pass.

10 Give and Go

Pass to a partner, cut to the hoop, get it back, and finish.

Coach tip: Speed up right after you pass — that's the 'go'.

Chapter 3 — Shooting

10 drills

1 Form Shooting

Stand close to the hoop and shoot one-handed, focusing on perfect form. Make 10.

Coach tip: Remember B.E.E.F: Balance, Eyes, Elbow in, Follow through.

2 Follow-Through Waves

After every shot, hold your follow-through and 'wave goodbye' to the ball until it lands.

Coach tip: A good wave means a good shot is on the way.

3 Around the Key

Shoot from 5 spots around the paint. Make one before you move to the next spot.

Coach tip: Square your shoulders to the rim at every spot.

4 Free Throw Routine

Do the same thing every free throw: bounce, breathe, shoot. Take 10.

Coach tip: Same routine every time builds a calm, steady shot.

5 Beat the Coach

Shoot from a spot; a make is 1 point for you, a miss is 1 for the coach. First to 5.

Coach tip: Slow down and aim — points beat rushing.

6 Catch and Shoot

A partner passes to you and you shoot right away in one motion.

Coach tip: Have your hands ready BEFORE the ball gets there.

7 Bank Shots

Practice shooting off the backboard square from the side angles. Make 5 each side.

Coach tip: Aim for the top corner of the little square.

8 21 (Knockout)

Line up and shoot; if the person behind you makes it before you, you're out. Fun with a group.

Coach tip: Rebound your OWN miss fast and put it back up.

9 Spot Shooting Ladder

Make 2 from spot 1, then 3 from spot 2, then 4 from spot 3.

Coach tip: If you miss, stay until you get the count.

10 Buzzer Beaters

Coach counts '3-2-1' — catch and shoot before the buzzer. Pretend it's the big game!

Coach tip: Quick feet, calm hands.



Chapter 4 — Layups & Finishing

10 drills

1 Right-Side Layups

Dribble in from the right, step right-left, and lay it soft off the square. Make 5.

Coach tip: High knee on the jump.

2 Left-Side Layups

Same from the left side, stepping left-right. Make 5. Lefties matter!

Coach tip: Use your left hand — practice makes it easy.

3 Mikan Drill

Stand under the hoop and lay it in with your right, catch, lay it with your left, back and forth.

Coach tip: Soft touch and quick feet — a classic!

4 Speed Layups

Dribble in fast and finish under control. Don't let speed mess up your touch.

Coach tip: Fast to the rim, gentle at the rim.

5 Power Layups

Jump off TWO feet and go up strong through contact.

Coach tip: Be strong and balanced — protect the ball.

6 Reverse Layups

Go under the hoop and finish on the other side, away from the defender.

Coach tip: Use the rim to hide the ball.

7 Layup Lines

Two lines: one shoots layups, one rebounds and passes out. Keep it moving.

Coach tip: Say 'ball!' when you catch the rebound.

8 Finish Through Contact

A coach gives a soft bump with a pad while you finish the layup.

Coach tip: Stay strong and keep your eyes on the target.

9 Floater Practice

From a few steps out, float a soft shot up and over. Great for little players vs. tall ones.

Coach tip: High and soft, off your fingertips.

10 Coast to Coast

Grab a rebound, dribble the length of the court, finish a layup.

Coach tip: Control the ball, then explode to the rim.



Chapter 5 — Defense

10 drills

1 Defensive Slides

Stay low, feet wide, and slide side to side without crossing your feet. 30 seconds.

Coach tip: Push and slide — never hop, never cross.

2 Mirror Drill

Face a partner; they move slow, you stay right in front like a mirror.

Coach tip: Watch their belly button, not their fancy moves.

3 Close Out

Sprint to a shooter, then chop your feet and get your hands up under control.

Coach tip: Don't fly by — break down and be balanced.

4 Deny the Pass

Stand between your player and the ball with a hand in the passing lane.

Coach tip: See your player AND the ball at the same time.

5 Steal the Cookie

Attacker dribbles; defender times a clean poke at the ball (no reaching fouls).

Coach tip: Take the ball when it's low, not the arm.

6 Box Out

When a shot goes up, turn, find your player, and put your back into them to grab the rebound.

Coach tip: Hit first, then go get the ball.

7 1-on-1 Stops

Play one-on-one; the defender wins by getting 3 stops before the attacker scores twice.

Coach tip: Stay low the WHOLE time — tired defenders reach and foul.

8 Take the Charge (soft)

Practice stepping in front and falling safely onto a mat when the attacker drives.

Coach tip: Feet set, arms crossed, take it on the chest.

9 Zig-Zag Defense

Slide with a dribbler as they zig-zag down the court, staying in front.

Coach tip: Beat them to the spot.

10 Help and Recover

Slide over to help a teammate, then hurry back to your own player.

Coach tip: Talk! Yell 'help!' so your team knows.



Chapter 6 — Rebounding & Hustle

8 drills

1 Grab and Chin

Catch a rebound and pull it tight under your chin with elbows out.

Coach tip: Never let the ball dangle low where it gets stolen.

2 Tip Drill

Tip the ball off the backboard to yourself a few times, then grab it strong.

Coach tip: Soft fingertips on the tips.

3 Two-Hand Grab

Coach tosses the ball off the rim; you jump and grab it with TWO hands.

Coach tip: Two hands are stronger than one.

4 Loose Ball Dive

On 'GO', hustle after a rolling ball and grab it before your partner.

Coach tip: First to the floor usually gets the ball.

5 Rebound and Outlet

Grab the board, turn to the sideline, and make a strong outlet pass.

Coach tip: Look up the court the moment you land.

6 Superman

Toss the ball out, run and grab it in the air, land in balance.

Coach tip: Big effort — rebounds are about want-to.

7 Circle the Rim

Two players tap the ball back and forth off the backboard, staying up strong.

Coach tip: Quick jumps, don't come all the way down.

8 Box Out Battle

On the shot, box out your partner for 3 seconds so they can't get the ball.

Coach tip: Feel where they are with your back.



Chapter 7 — Footwork & Moves

8 drills

1 Jump Stop

Dribble, then land on both feet at the same time in balance.

Coach tip: Stick the landing like a gymnast.

2 Pivot Practice

Keep one foot planted and swing the other around to face different ways.

Coach tip: Stay low so a pivot doesn't wobble.

3 Triple Threat

Catch the ball ready to shoot, pass, OR dribble — knees bent, ball by your hip.

Coach tip: Be a threat to do all three.

4 Jab Step

Fake a step one way to make the defender lean, then go the other way.

Coach tip: Sell the fake with your eyes.

5 Crossover Move

Dribble at a cone, cross the ball low, and change direction fast.

Coach tip: Low and quick — the crossover is a whisper, not a shout.

6 V-Cut

Walk your defender in, then cut out hard to get open in a V shape.

Coach tip: Change speed — slow, then FAST.

7 Drop Step

In the post, feel the defender and step through them toward the hoop.

Coach tip: Big strong step, ball protected.

8 Euro-Step (older kids)

Take two steps in different directions to slide past a defender to the rim.

Coach tip: Learn layups first, this comes later.

Chapter 8 — Conditioning & Warm-Ups

8 drills

1 Line Touches

Sprint and touch each line on the court, coming back each time (suicides — but fun!).

Coach tip: Bend and touch the line with your hand.

2 High Knees

Run in place bringing knees up high for 20 seconds.

Coach tip: Pump your arms too.

3 Defensive Slide Lengths

Slide from sideline to sideline in your defensive stance, 4 times.

Coach tip: Stay low the whole way — no standing up.

4 Star Jumps

10 big jumping jacks that turn into star shapes in the air.

Coach tip: Explode up, land soft.

5 Dribble Sprints

Dribble as fast as you can under control from one end to the other.

Coach tip: Speed with control, not speed with chaos.

6 Lane Slides

Slide around the paint (the key) staying low, both directions.

Coach tip: Quiet, quick feet.

7 Arm Circles

10 forward, 10 backward to loosen your shoulders before shooting.

Coach tip: Warm shoulders shoot better.

8 Cool-Down Stretch

After practice, gently stretch legs and arms and take slow breaths.

Coach tip: Never skip the cool-down — it keeps you healthy.



Chapter 9 — Fun Team Games

8 drills

1 Knockout

Two balls, everyone in line. Make your shot before the person behind you or you're out.

Coach tip: Grab your miss and put it back FAST.

2 Sharks and Minnows

Everyone dribbles across; 'sharks' try to knock balls away without fouling.

Coach tip: Keep the ball low and protected.

3 Dribble Tag

Everyone dribbles while a tagger (also dribbling) tries to tag them.

Coach tip: You can't stop dribbling to get away!

4 Relay Races

Teams race doing dribble-to-the-cone-and-layup, then tag the next player.

Coach tip: Cheer for your teammates!

5 Around the World

Make shots from spots around the key in order. First all the way around wins.

Coach tip: Slow down and aim at each spot.

6 Steal the Bacon

Two teams; coach calls a number, those players race for the ball in the middle.

Coach tip: Explode on your number.

7 Musical Basketballs

Dribble around; when the music stops, freeze in triple threat.

Coach tip: Freeze low and balanced.

8 Beat the Clock

As a team, make 20 layups before the timer runs out.

Coach tip: Work together, keep the line moving.

★ Chapter 10 — Team Play & Being a Good Teammate

8 drills

1 Spacing

Spread out so the floor is big — don't all run to the ball.

Coach tip: Give your teammate room to make a move.

2 Pass Ahead

When you get a rebound, look to pass up the court to a running teammate.

Coach tip: The pass is faster than the dribble.

3 Setting a Screen

Stand still and strong to block a defender so your teammate gets open.

Coach tip: Set your feet — don't move once you're there.

4 Talk on Defense

Yell 'ball!', 'help!', 'shot!' so everyone knows what's happening.

Coach tip: The loudest team is usually the best defense.

5 Cheer From the Bench

When you're resting, cheer loud for your team.

Coach tip: Great teammates cheer as hard as they play.

6 Shake Hands

Say 'good game' and shake hands, win or lose.

Coach tip: Winning is fun, but being kind matters more.

7 Hustle Back

When the other team gets the ball, sprint back on defense.

Coach tip: First one back stops the easy basket.

8 Do Your Job

Play YOUR position and trust your teammates to play theirs.

Coach tip: A team of helpers beats a team of heroes.

Go Team MO! 🏀 You're going to be a great coach!